

YouKnowBall — Player Data Field Reference

Dataset schema & question-mapping guide for the backend rebuild · 2,836 players · Top 5 European leagues · 2025-26 season (FBref)

Purpose of this document. The backend is moving to a new, clean dataset (`players_enriched.json`). This reference defines every field, what it contains, and — critically — **which user question each field answers**. Use it to build the candidate-filter engine and the NLP intent → field mapping. The core principle holds: the LLM interprets a question into one of these fields; the dataset decides the YES/NO/UNKNOWN answer. The LLM never answers from its own knowledge.

Dataset at a glance

Total players: 2,836 | **Leagues:** Premier League, La Liga, Serie A, Bundesliga, Ligue 1 | **Every player has real appearance data** (no empty/ghost records — this is the fix for the old weak-filtering bug). **Difficulty pools (cumulative):** Easy 1,087 (1500+ min) · Medium 1,945 (500+ min) · Hard 2,836 (all).

1 · Identity & Position

Field	Type	Answers the question...	Notes / values
<code>name</code>	string	Final guess matching	Full player name. Used for the guess check, not questions.
<code>nationality</code>	string	<i>"Is he Brazilian?"</i>	Full country name ("Norway", not "NOR"). 115 nationalities. This is eligibility, not caps — do not use for "does he play for [national team]".
<code>position</code>	DEF/MID/ATK/GK	<i>"Is he a midfielder?"</i>	Primary position. MID 1253, DEF 848, ATK 541, GK 194.
<code>positions</code>	list	<i>"Is he versatile?"</i> / dual-role match	All positions a player covers, e.g. <code>["MID", "ATK"]</code> . "Is he an attacker?" should return YES if ATK is in this list, even if primary is MID.
<code>is_gk</code>	boolean	<i>"Is he a goalkeeper?"</i>	Also drives the flank-box auto-lock on the card (GKs have no flank).

2 · Geography (continent & region)

Closes the "Is he European?" gap — these are derived from `nationality` via static maps.

Field	Type	Answers the question...	Notes / values
<code>continent</code>	string	<i>"Is he European / African / South American?"</i>	Europe 2083, Africa 390, S.America 255, N.America 60, Asia 43, Oceania 5. Every player has one.
<code>region</code>	string / null	<i>"Is he Scandinavian / West African / Balkan?"</i>	Sub-continental tag where football-relevant: Scandinavian, British Isles, Iberian, West African, Balkan, Maghreb, Baltic, Nordic, Middle Eastern, Gulf, North Africa. null where none notable (1,300 of 2,836 tagged).

3 · Club, City & League

Field	Type	Answers the question...	Notes / values
<code>club</code>	string	<i>"Does he play for Barcelona?"</i>	96 clubs. Parser must resolve nicknames ("Barca" → Barcelona, "Spurs" → Tottenham) before matching.
<code>city</code>	string	<i>"Does he play for a Manchester club?"</i>	Club's city. 12 multi-club cities enable group questions: London (7), Madrid (4), Manchester/Milan/Rome/Turin/Seville/Valencia/Paris/Liverpool/Barcelona/Hamburg

(2 each).

league	string	"Does he play in the Premier League / in Spain?"	One of the 5 leagues. Maps to a country for "plays in [country]" questions.
big_club	boolean	"Does he play for a big club?"	924 players. Traditional top/European-regular sides (31 clubs). Adjustable set — it's a judgment call, not a hard fact.

4 • Age

Field	Type	Answers the question...	Notes / values
age	int	"Is he under 21? / over 30? / a teenager?"	Parser extracts a number + comparison (age < 21). Point-in-time; refreshes with weekly data updates.
born	int (year)	"Was he born in the 2000s?"	Birth year.

5 · Playing Time & Role

Field	Type	Answers the question...	Notes / values
minutes	int	Difficulty tiering; "regular player?"	Season minutes. Drives the difficulty pools.
matches	int	"Has he played 20+ games?"	Appearances this season.
difficulty	easy/medium/hard	Pool selection (not a user question)	easy=1500+ min (1087), medium=500+ (858), hard=<500 (891). Cumulative when building pools.
is_starter	boolean	"Is he a regular starter?"	19+ starts. 970 players.
is_supersub	boolean	"Is he mostly a sub?"	Subbed on more than started, with 250+ min. 460 players.
is_everpresent	boolean	"Does he play every week?"	30+ starts.

6 · Scoring & Creativity

Field	Type	Answers the question...	Notes / values
goals	int	"Has he scored this season?"	Raw season goals.
assists	int	"Does he provide assists?"	Raw season assists.
goals_bracket	0 / 1-4 / 5-9 / 10+	"Has he scored 10+ goals?"	10+ : 93 players, 5-9 : 235, 1-4 : 1082, 0 : 1426. Strong narrowing clue.
assists_bracket	0 / 1-4 / 5-9 / 10+	"Has he got 10+ assists?"	10+ is very rare (≈10 players) — huge clue.
double_double	boolean	"Is he a 10-goal AND 10-assist player?"	Only 3 players. Near game-ending clue.

7 · Penalties & Discipline

Field	Type	Answers the question...	Notes / values
penalty_taker	boolean	"Is he his team's penalty taker?"	2+ penalty attempts. 121 players.
sent_off	boolean	"Has he been sent off this season?"	1+ red card. 320 players.
scored_own_goal	boolean	"Has he scored an own goal?!"	118 players. Fun, embarrassing clue.
discipline	clean/average/dirty	"Is he a dirty player?"	By fouls per 90 (percentile). dirty 426, average 1559, clean 851.
heavily_booked	boolean	"Has he had a lot of yellows?"	6+ yellow cards.

8 · Style Tags per-90, relative

Computed on per-90 stats at the 85th percentile, so subs and starters are judged fairly. These are *relative* ("a lot for the league"), not absolute counts.

Field	Type	Answers the question...	Notes
big_crosser	boolean	"Does he cross a lot?" (winger/FB signal)	Top 15% crosses/90.
ball_winner	boolean	"Is he a ball-winner?"	Top 15% (interceptions + tackles)/90.
gets_fouled	boolean	"Does he get fouled a lot?" (dribbler)	Top 15% fouls won/90.
shoots_a_lot	boolean	"Does he shoot a lot?"	Top 15% shots/90.

high_ppm	boolean	"Does his team win when he plays?"	2.0+ points per match.
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9 · Goalkeeper-specific

Field	Type	Answers the question...	Notes
gk_clean_sheets	int	"Has he kept 10+ clean sheets?"	0 for outfield players.
gk_strong	boolean	"Is he a top keeper?"	GK with 10+ clean sheets. Makes GKs guessable instead of dead-ends.

10 · Implementation notes for the backend rebuild

- Candidate-filter engine.** Every question resolves to a field + value, then narrows the candidate pool by that field. Because every player has complete data, "not Premier League" now removes *all* non-PL players (the old ghost-player bug — where data-less players survived every filter — is gone). Pool should shrink meaningfully on each answer.
- NLP intent mapping.** The parser's job is to map a natural question to one field above. Build the intent list directly from this doc's fields. Handle: nicknames (club/city), demonyms ("Finnish" → Finland) and slang ("Aussie" → Australia), number+comparison extraction (age, goals brackets), and category words ("European" → continent, "Scandinavian" → region).
- Known boundaries — return UNKNOWN, don't guess.** Not in this dataset: preferred foot, height, market value, trophies, career/club history, national-team caps, manager history. If a question maps to one of these, return UNKNOWN and log it. (These would require external data sources — future work.)

Uniform schema

Every player object has the **same 37 fields** in the same shape (booleans, small categories, ints, strings). This consistency is intentional — the filter engine and card-reveal logic can treat every player identically.

Generated for the YouKnowBall backend migration. Source: players_enriched.json (FBref 2025-26, top-5 leagues). Field counts current as of this dataset build.